

TAB 15



Board of Education Report

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Ms. Goldberg - Supporting Meaningful Teaching and Learning in the LAUSD Community Schools Initiative (Res-003-23/24) For Action September 10, 2024

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District Community Schools Initiative (CSI), in alignment with the California Community Schools Framework defines a Community School as one that takes a “whole-child” approach, with “an integrated focus on academics, health and social services, youth and community development, and community engagement”;

Whereas, Community Schools require expertise and assistance to develop a strong instructional and performance assessment program that is based on the science of learning and development--which finds that students learn best when curriculum, teaching, and assessment strategies are built on students’ prior knowledge and experiences, and focus on relevant and engaging learning tasks;

Whereas, Research (Cotton, 2003; Hallinger, 2003; Leithwood, Louis, Anderson & Wahlstrom, 2004, Robinson 2007) consistently shows that the principal’s instructional leadership role has a strong influence on learner performance and asserts that learner performance is likely to be greater where there is direct principal leadership involvement in planning and professional development;

Whereas, The UCLA Center for Transformation of Schools has identified obstacles to retaining Black, Indigenous, and People of Color (BIPOC) teachers and recommends that administrators and schools make a strong, lasting commitment to “the ideals and policies that best support students in cultivating critical awareness” and that “the use of standardized tests should be dramatically reduced and supplemented with more authentic and relevant performance assessment”;

Whereas, Performance assessment aligns with community-based learning because it enables students to demonstrate their learning in authentic ways and apply their knowledge and skills to new contexts by creating products, presentations and/or demonstrations that reflect understanding and mastery; and

Whereas, Hiring Community School Lead Teachers who rely on performance assessment versus student preparation for standardized testing will allow Community Schools to better support all five pillars of LAUSD’s 2022-2026 Strategic Plan (Academic Excellence, Joy and Wellness, Engagement and Collaboration, Operational Effectiveness, and Investing in Staff); now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That schools that participate in one of the five CSI cohorts will be eligible to apply to participate in the Supporting Meaningful Teaching and Learning Initiative, and the Community Schools Steering Committee (CSSC) will recommend approval or denial of applications;

Resolved further, That Cohort participants will be authorized to hire a Community Schools Grant funded Community School Lead Teacher through the Community Schools Partnership Program (CCSPP), who will support the goal of “remodeling instructional program commitment”;

Resolved further, That Lead Teachers will receive professional development by Community School Coaches and UCLA Center for Community Schooling, as well as other relevant partners as appropriate;

Resolved further, That Cohort participants will demonstrate a team commitment that includes, at minimum, the principal and school staff, and will commit to participating in the Cohort for three years;

Resolved further, That Cohort participants will commit to remodeling their existing instruction program to integrate culturally relevant curriculum, community- and project-based learning, and civic engagement (e.g., through the integration of Linked Learning and/or other instructional strategies), and targeted AI integration;

Resolved further, That Community Schools Principals will commit to engaging in instructional planning, observation of project- based instruction, attend and provide professional development related to community- and project-based learning, and provide sufficient resources for teachers to fully implement project-based learning.

Resolved further, That approved Cohort participants, at their own discretion and subject to their own determination, will be excused from any and all standardized testing with the exception of state-and federally-mandated statewide assessment; and, be it finally

Resolved, That District staff, UNITE-LA staff, and labor and other partners will form a team to develop the operational aspects of the Supporting Meaningful Teaching and Learning Initiative, develop a plan for how this initiative is communicated across the systems and structures of the CSI, and create an application and rubric for approval so that this new initiative can begin August 2024.